The Pink Proxy

FREE RESOURCE FOR TEAMS OF 3–10

# The 5-Minute Cyber Hygiene Checklist

Ten plain-English checks that cover where most small-business security problems start. No IT background needed.

**1. Check the box**
Tick each item that is fully true for your business today.

**2. Read the quick fix**
For any unchecked item, the quick fix is your next step.

**3. Count your score**
Total your checks on page 2 to see where you stand.

## 01 Every team member has their own login

PR.AA

WHY IT MATTERS
Shared logins make it impossible to know who did what, or to cut off one person without locking out everyone.

QUICK FIX
Give each person their own account for email, banking and payment tools. Retire any shared "admin@" logins.

## 02 Multi-factor sign-in is on for email

PR.AA

WHY IT MATTERS
Email is the key to every other account, since password resets go there. A stolen password alone shouldn't open it.

QUICK FIX
Turn on 2-Step Verification for every user, ideally with an authenticator app instead of text messages.

## 03 Passwords live in a password manager

PR.AA

WHY IT MATTERS
Passwords in Slack, texts or spreadsheets get copied, forwarded and forgotten. One leak exposes everything.

QUICK FIX
Set up a business password manager with shared folders, then delete old password messages and files.

## 04 You could remove a departing employee in under an hour

GV.RR

WHY IT MATTERS
Former staff and contractors with live access are one of the most common causes of small-business data loss.

QUICK FIX
List every app each person can access. Turn that list into a written offboarding checklist you follow every time.

## 05 Your domain has a DMARC record

PR.PS

WHY IT MATTERS
Without SPF, DKIM and DMARC, anyone can send email that looks like it came from you, including fake invoices to your clients.

QUICK FIX
Ask whoever manages your domain to confirm all three records exist, then move DMARC toward enforcement.

### 06 Laptops lock automatically and are encrypted

PR.DS

WHY IT MATTERS

A lost or stolen laptop with no encryption hands over every file and saved login on it.

QUICK FIX

Turn on FileVault (Mac) or BitLocker (Windows) and set screens to lock after 5 minutes idle.

### 07 Software updates install automatically

PR.PS

WHY IT MATTERS

Most attacks use flaws that already have a fix. Updates close those doors.

QUICK FIX

Turn on automatic updates for operating systems, browsers and phones used for work. Restart weekly.

### 08 Files are backed up, and you've tested a restore

PR.DS

WHY IT MATTERS

Ransomware and accidental deletion happen. A backup you have never restored is only a guess.

QUICK FIX

Confirm what is backed up and where, then restore one real file this week to prove it works.

### 09 Guests use a separate Wi-Fi network

PR.IR

WHY IT MATTERS

Visitors' devices on your main network can see your printers, shared drives and work computers.

QUICK FIX

Turn on your router's guest network for visitors, and change the router's default admin password.

### 10 You know who to call if something goes wrong

RS.MA

WHY IT MATTERS

In the first hour of an incident, panic wastes time. A short plan keeps everyone calm and focused.

QUICK FIX

Write one page: who to call, how to reach your bank and email provider, and which accounts to lock first.

MY SCORE

___ / 10

## What your score means

| | |
|---|---|
| 0–4 | Some doors are open. Start with items 1–4; they prevent the most common problems. |
| 5–7 | Good habits started. Lock in access, offboarding and email authentication next. |
| 8–9 | Strong foundation. A quick review will confirm the details and close the last gaps. |
| 10 | Excellent. Re-check every quarter as your team and tools change. |

## Want help closing the gaps?

Book a Cyber Hygiene Audit. In under a week you'll know exactly where you stand and what to fix first, explained in plain English.

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Item tags (e.g. PR.AA) show which NIST Cybersecurity Framework 2.0 category each check relates to. This mapping is informational only and does not indicate certification, compliance or endorsement by NIST or any government agency. This checklist is general guidance, not legal or professional advice, and completing it does not guarantee protection against security incidents. © 2026 The Pink Proxy.